

VA – INTERMEDIATE 1

Directions for questions 1 and 2: There are two blanks in each of the following sentences.

From the pairs of words given below each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

The digital disruption has brought in its wake a new sense of _____ to the profession of journalism which was guided by _____ principles that helped it to stand in good stead for nearly two centuries.

☐ a) incertitude . . . radical

☒ b) uncertainty . . . cardinal (Your answer - ✓)

☐ c) orderliness . . . lofty

☐ d) dubiety . . . esteemed

Directions for questions 1 and 2: There are two blanks in each of the following sentences.

From the pairs of words given below each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

A mature political debate will, with great care, identify the specific constituencies and _____ their grievances rather than _____ about the terms of the Preamble.

☐ a) redress . . . quibble (Correct Answer - ✓)

☒ b) resolve . . . cavil (Your answer - ✗)

☐ c) assuage . . . carp

☐ d) mitigate . . . fulminate

Directions for questions 3 and 4: Each of the following questions presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context and indicate the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

(A) Miller's other sporting import, rugby, had less appeal.

(B) Asked which sport would grow most, more Brazilians picked rugby than others in a survey conducted in 2011 by Deloitte, a consultancy.

(C) When Charles Miller, son of an English railway engineer posted to Brazil, returned to Sao Paulo from a British boarding school in 1894, he brought back a foot-ball and popularized a game that would help define Brazilian identity.

(D) But now rugby is beginning to find a mass audience.

(E) It was played at a few posh boarding schools and almost nowhere else.

Directions for questions 3 and 4: Each of the following questions presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context and indicate the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

(A) India rarely had any intelligence paradigms to refer to or fall back upon to strengthen its maritime and territorial boundaries.

(B) Britain mastered the Asian continent and France the African, even as both countries succeeded in colonizing India – France partially but Britain substantively.

(C) While narratives on the freedom struggle varyingly interpreted the British rule over India as negative, enduring or unconstitutional, none could substantively analyze how India came under British subjugation around 1748.

(D) Countries like Britain and France, both front-line colonists, had an advantage over the rest of the world in that their mastery over their "intelligence arenas" was always strong.

(E) One major zone of national operational activity that separated the not-so-integrated Bharatvarsha of yore and British imperialists was "generation, accumulation and utilization of intelligence in national endeavors".

Directions for questions 5 to 7: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence of sentences in the box provided below each question.

(1) India, Thailand and Japan have all made strides in the market, a feat once thought impossible due to unfavorable climates.

(2) But China is not the only Asian country whose wineries have been receiving favorable reviews.

(3) In the future, one can expect to see the diversity of grape varieties expand as well as the types of wine available

(4) Last year, when Berry Bros. and Rudd, the UK's oldest wine merchant and vintner to the Queen, announced that it was permanently stocking four wines by Chinese winery Chateau Changyu, it confirmed an important development: China is now producing quality wines.

(5) However, improvements in viniculture and winemaking standards have enabled Asian winemakers to work around this disadvantage by growing grapes that thrive in these conditions.

Solution:

(1) cannot begin the paragraph as market is undefined. (4) introduces Chinese wines and (2) checks (4). (1) substantiates (2). once thought impossible in (1) is followed by revisions in (5). (3) ends the paragraph on a positive note. Ans : (42153)

Directions for questions 5 to 7: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence of sentences in the box provided below each question.

- (1) The Lodge of Dundee, established in the '70s, is a cosy spot overlooking Dundee Beach.
- (2) We ordered beers and contemplated the serene view of palm trees against the backdrop of the glistening sea.
- (3) Our first two stops were old-school pubs catering to Darwin's fishing communities.
- (4) Meanwhile, in Crab Claw Island, another beach-front pub, the walls are adorned with photos of anglers showing off their barramundis.
- (5) Once a month, the island's resident crocodile, the 4.5m-long Mick Dundee, can be seen crawling a few meters offshore.

Solution:

(1) cannot begin the paragraph as it is the first stop in the itinerary mentioned in (3).
(2) cannot begin the paragraph as we hardly know where the scenic place is.
(3) mentions two stops, and since Crab Claw Island is another beach-front pub, the first is The Lodge of Dundee. (5) follows (1). (2) follows (4), as the crocodile is the highlight of Dundee.
Ans : (31524)

Directions for questions 5 to 7: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence of sentences in the box provided below each question.

- (1) And these workers' faith in the organization had declined.
- (2) The Nixon administration's startlingly candid 1972 survey, *Work in America*, found much of the greatest work dissatisfaction in the country among young, well-educated workers who were in low paying, dull, routine, and fractionated clerical positions.
- (3) Management has exacerbated this problem by viewing white-collar workers as expendable.
- (4) Today, many white-collar workers have lost personal touch with decision makers, and, consequently, they feel estranged from the goals of the organizations in which they work.
- (5) Because their productivity is hard to measure and their functions often non-essential, they are seen as the easiest place to 'cut fat' during low points in the business cycle.

Solution:

(4) cannot begin the paragraph as it is an afterthought to the survey in (2). 'These workers' in (1) refers to the ones in (2). 'This problem' in (3) refers to (4). 'Their' in (5) refers to white-collar workers in (3).
Ans : (21435)

Directions for questions 8 and 9: The following question has a paragraph from which the last sentence has been deleted. From the given options, choose the one that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

India was recently in the news for the wrong reasons. The serious threat posed by the newly discovered microbe, NDM –1, resistant to many antibiotics, triggered alarm and panic. The country faces two conflicting challenges. The urban rich with their easy access to medical treatment often receive inappropriate antibiotic therapy. On the other hand the rural poor, with their lack of basic medical facilities, find it difficult to obtain such medication. The official reactions to both these problems and their implications were denials. _____

- ☐ a) The actions of the rich result in microbial resistance, while the poor suffer preventable deaths.
- ☐ b) The development of bacterial resistance to antibiotics is natural and occurs due to adaption to hostile environments.
- ☐ c) The increase in antibiotic resistance in community acquired infection compounds the problem.

- ☒ d) However, after the short lived indignation and outrage, it is back to business as usual, the old inertia with its deceptive calm. (Correct Answer - ✓)

Hide Correct Answer

Hide Solution

PREVIOUS

NEXT

Solution:

Option (A) extends the idea discussed in the passage.
Option (B) does not gel with the contents of the para and hence can be ruled out.
Option (C) brings in a new idea and hence cannot be the conclusion.
Option (D) ends the idea introduced in the passage aptly. Choice (D)

Directions for questions 8 and 9: The following question has a paragraph from which the last sentence has been deleted. From the given options, choose the one that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

There is clear evidence that, across emerging markets, central banks are under pressure to raise interest rates despite slowing growth. The principal reason for this is the 'taper' or the gradual reduction in the Federal Reserve's purchases of U.S. Treasury Bonds. The taper is expected to push up interest rates in the developed countries. _____.

- ☐ a) This is, in turn, forcing emerging markets to raise their own interest rates in the hope that they can prevent the imposition, by developed countries, of high duties on goods produced in the emerging markets.
- ☐ b) This is, in turn, forcing emerging markets to raise their own interest rates in the hope that they can prevent the dumping in their markets of goods manufactured in developed countries.
- ☐ c) This is, in turn, forcing emerging markets to raise their own interest rates in the hope that they can compete with the developed countries on equal terms.
- ☐ d) This is, in turn, forcing emerging markets to raise their own interest rates in the hope that they can prevent a massive outflow of capital.

Solution:

The 1st sentence in the paragraph tells us that central banks in emerging markets are under pressure to raise interest rates. The two sentences that follow give us the reason for this pressure. The paragraph is to end with a sentence that tells us what situation the central banks in emerging markets are trying to prevent. Since we have been told that emerging markets are preparing to raise interest rates in response to an expected rise in interest rates in developed countries following the Fed Reserve's taper, we can infer that it is to stop the outflow of capital from emerging markets to developing countries, as, logically, capital is invested in the markets where the returns are the highest. So the blank is to be filled by option D.

Options A, B and C are incorrect because there is no co-relation between the situations they say the central banks are looking to prevent (imposition of high duties, dumping, competing on unequal terms) and the fact that emerging markets are under pressure to raise interest rates in response to an expected rise in interest rates in developed countries.

Choice (D)

Directions for question 10: In the following question, there are five sentences. Each sentence has pairs of words / phrases that are italicized and highlighted. From the italicized and highlighted words / phrases select the most appropriate words /phrases to form correct sentences. Then from the options given choose the best one.

His father was tired of his ***fictional*** [a] / ***fictitious*** [b] excuses for failing in the examination every year.

Rea was initially hesitant to join the new party but soon she realised that many of the faces were ***familiar to*** [a] ***familiar with*** [b] her.

Last week the offender was finally ***haled*** [a] / ***hailed*** [b] before the judge.

The prodigal son had the ***timidity*** [a] / ***temerity*** [b] to question his father's judgement.

As it ***transposed*** [a] ***transpired*** [b] the minster did not dare go against the Khap Panchayat.

- ☐ a) baabb
- ☐ b) abaab
- ☐ c) babab
- ☐ d) baaab

Solution:

Fictional means related to a fiction, a work of the imagination – novel, play or movie. Something fictitious is not genuine. Hence (b).

'Familiar with' indicates 'having a good knowledge of'. 'Familiar to' implies a lesser degree of familiarity. Hence (a).

Hale, (verb) means to haul or drag, hail, verb, means to attract attention or to greet enthusiastically. Hence (a).

Timidity is the tendency to be easily frightened whereas temerity means foolish, reckless boldness. Hence (b).

Transposed means 'to change in form or nature' and transpired means 'to be revealed or come to light'. Hence (b). Therefore baabb. Choice (A)

Directions for questions 11 and 12: In each of the following questions, the word at the top is used in four different ways, A to D. Choose the option in which the usage of the word is INCORRECT or INAPPROPRIATE.

DELIBERATE

- ☐ a) He made a deliberate attempt to malign her reputation.
- ☐ b) The actor delivered his dialogue with deliberate dramatics.
- ☒ c) The ministers have to deliberate how to win the election. (Correct Answer - ✓)
- ☐ d) The Commander spoke with deliberate pauses so that the soldiers could understand the plan of action.

Directions for questions 11 and 12: In each of the following questions, the word at the top is used in four different ways, A to D. Choose the option in which the usage of the word is INCORRECT or INAPPROPRIATE.

LIFTED

- ☐ a) The mother lifted the child over the hedge easily.
- ☐ b) Curfew was lifted in Srinagar after peace was reported.
- ☐ c) They lifted the passages from the original and passed it off as their own.
- ☒ d) The reporter lifted the lid on the machinations within the political party. (Correct Answer - ✓)

Directions for question 13: Four alternative summaries are given below the following text.

Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text.

Adi Shankara propounded the 'Advaita' philosophy which in essence refutes the twin existence of paramatma or the almighty and jeevatma, the human being. He says that everything we see, hear and touch in this world is but a manifestation of God. He goes on to aver that it is 'maya' or the veil of ignorance that makes one feel that everything in this world is real. But he realized the difficulty of the laity understanding his philosophy which can be appreciated purely from an intellectual plane. Hence for the ordinary man and woman, he recommended the worship of Gods. In fact he was the founder of Shanmatha – six religions – which advocates the worship of different Gods of the Hindu pantheon.

- ☐ a) Adi Shankara's Advaita philosophy avers that God and human beings are not distinct and worldly beings are manifestations of God. 'Maya' hides this. As people cannot understand this, he recommended the worship of Gods, establishing six religions.
- ☐ b) Adi Shankara refuted the existence of God and human beings. Everything in this world is a manifestation of God hidden by ignorance. As this is esoteric, he advocated worship of Gods by establishing six religions.
- ☐ c) Advaita enunciated by Adi Shankara repudiates the separate existence of God and human beings. Ignorance veils this truth. For the easier understanding by the layman he promoted worship of Gods by establishing six religions.
- ☐ d) Adi Shankara – the proponent of Advaita – disputed the twin nature of God and human beings. He declared that everything is imaginary but as the common people cannot understand this, he established six religions.

Solution:

In choice (B) the first line is incorrect. He did not refute the existence. He refuted only their separate existence. In (C) the line 'for the easier understanding' gives the impression that 'by following worship of Gods', the layman can understand the Advaita philosophy. This is wrong. In (D) the point – that he established religions to enable people to worship Gods because they cannot understand the esoteric nature of the advaita philosophy – is missing. Only (A) is correct. Choice (A)

Directions for question 14: In the following question, there are five sentences or parts of sentences that form a paragraph. Identify the sentence(s) or part(s) of sentence(s) that is/are correct in terms of grammar and usage. Then, choose the **most appropriate** option.

- a. Universities have not changed much since students first gathered in Oxford and Bologna in the 11th century.
- b. Teaching had been constrained by technology.
- c. Until recently a student needed to be in a lecture hall to hear the professor or around a table to debate with fellow students.
- d. Innovation is eliminating those constraints, however,
- e. and bringing sweeping changes to higher education.

☐ a) b and c

☒ b) a, d and e (Your answer - ✓)

☐ c) a, b and e

☐ d) a, b and c

Directions for question 15: The following question presents 4 statements of which 3, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context corresponding and indicate the number corresponding with it in the box provided below the question.

- (1) It is time for Indians to understand the costs of capital punishment, and its utter uselessness as a means of deterring crime.
- (2) The court also mandated humane treatment — if that phrase has any meaning in this context — of prisoners of death row.
- (3) Last week, the Supreme Court commuted the sentences of a woman and 14 men on death row, saying that long delays in ruling on their mercy petitions justified clemency.
- (4) It laid down new procedures for handling the process of capital punishment.

Solution:

The context, as understood from the sentences, is the Supreme Court's commuting death sentences on account of long delays in disposing of their mercy petitions. Sentences 3, 4 and 2 make a coherent paragraph. 3 introduces the topic; 4 adds to what is said in 3 as the pronoun 'it' in 4 refers back to the Supreme Court in 3. 2 further adds to what is said in 4. Sentence 1 is a general statement, which has no bearing on the subject discussed i.e. the Supreme Court's action. Ans : (1)